

Daifuku (6383.T): Logis-Tech Tokyo Takeaways: Technological innovation and intensifying competition confirmed, but Daifuku's positioning

We visited the international logistics exhibition held at Tokyo Big Sight on September 8-11, where we compared and conducted hearings on the solutions of warehouse automation / automated storage players, with a focus on Daifuku. The biggest takeaway we confirmed is arguably the bifurcation of the industry. (1) Alongside the rise of Chinese-made AGVs with lifting mechanisms, and the emergence of new technologies, price deflation and commoditization are progressing in the segment serving small- and mid-sized customers. Meanwhile, (2) for large-scale customers, the importance of high-value-added and application-specific equipment is, if anything, increasing. Under this structural change, we judge that Daifuku is likely to further solidify its top position in Japan through high-value-added offerings and scale-driven competitive advantage. We reiterate our Buy rating.

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Industry trends: bifurcation into commoditization vs. high-value-added

In the low-price segment, Chinese warehouse automation providers were exhibiting numerous solutions built around AGVs equipped with lifting mechanisms. For smaller volumes, it was evident that such general-purpose, low-cost solutions are adequately serving their purpose.

In the picking process, several companies exhibited machines configured with a humanoid-form upper body and an AGV lower body. The appeal is not throughput speed or accuracy but versatility, and development appears premised on entrusting these machines with more complex, non-standardized tasks in the future.

On the other hand, the major players are pursuing process-by-process specialization and optimization, and high-value-added differentiation through customization to customer specifications. While top-tier companies such as Daifuku and Murata Machinery are achieving differentiation along this axis, the majority of other players face a high risk of being drawn into low-price competition and falling behind on profitability. This structure re-emerged clearly from the exhibition as a whole.

Takeaways from our meeting with Daifuku Corporate Officer Mr. Chikashi

Nakamura: reconfirming Daifuku's competitive advantage

We had the opportunity to meet with Daifuku's IR team and Mr. Shin Nakamura, Managing Officer and General Manager of the Sales Division, Intralogistics Business Unit. We summarize the key points below.

(1) Development policy, storage/transport architecture, and differentiation

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According to Mr. Nakamura, against Chinese players who lead in certain new-type AGVs, domestic customers voice concerns over post-installation service and maintenance frameworks, and express a preference for Daifuku-supplied products. The company is expanding its lineup, including the 4-way type “Shuttle Rack LX,” and intends to differentiate through accommodation of customer specifications and post-installation support. The forklift-type AMR “SOTR F” is compatible with Japan’s double-sided pallets, with a minimum turning radius of 1m and turning space requirement roughly half that of other companies’ AGFs — a considerable focus on compactness.

On storage/transport architecture, the company judges that the more a customer’s applications are centered on large-scale, high-throughput use, the more efficient the “division-of-labor type” — separating the storage equipment from the transport vehicle — becomes, and it is developing accordingly. The climbing type, seen in some exhibits, in which the vehicle ascends and descends the rack under its own power, is suited to small-scale applications but faces challenges in scaling up. While Chinese players with lifting-mechanism AGVs were conspicuous, the shared view was that the industry current is probably shifting toward the division-of-labor type.

(2) Current level of automation, and the roles of humanoids and WES

In Mr. Nakamura’s sense, the unmanned ratio — effectively the automation level — of today’s most advanced automated warehouses is around 85%. To the question of how the remaining 15% can be automated, a clear answer was given: of that 15%, roughly 10 points — two-thirds — would be filled by humanoids, and the remaining 5 points — one-third — by automation of human judgment and operations. These are not measured figures but his own view; that caveat aside, they are sufficiently instructive.

Humanoids are currently valued for flexibility rather than speed, with assumed applications including unloading from trucks and work in locations that existing transport vehicles struggle to enter due to unevenness or inclines. For operational judgment, the aim is to optimize tasks and labor allocation by leveraging data and AI through WES (Warehouse Execution System). Our impression is that, on the feasibility timeline, the latter will arrive somewhat earlier. It was also noted that if humanoid speed improves in the future, a portion of the already-automated 85% could also be substituted.

(3) Timeline to practical deployment and future direction

The company targets 2030 as the point at which solutions including humanoids are generally supplied. Daifuku is also developing a humanoid, but there was no actual machine on display at this exhibition. While video displays and picking-process demonstrations were shown at other companies’ booths as well, the company’s view is that this alone is insufficient. At the same time, the concept is not one humanoid handling all tasks; rather, the company sees the division of roles with existing equipment becoming clearly defined. Finally, 2030 is purely a target, and no timing by Japan/US or specific penetration rates were indicated. The WES-related area noted above looks achievable earlier, whereas utilization of humanoids will be difficult unless their realism as a suitably low-cost solution increases.

Overall: Moving further up the value curve and cementing its position

Throughout the meeting, we heard no comment from Mr. Nakamura that viewed the

current situation pessimistically; the discussion focused throughout on how the company intends to capture this burgeoning, robust demand. Given its high domestic market share and superior technological capabilities, its earnings structure should be solid. Short-term earnings trends swing with the revenue recognition progress of individual projects, and 2Q IL division results were therefore held at a subdued level. However, we believe this visit produced enough positive evidence to suggest that such concerns will prove unfounded over the medium to long term. We maintain our bullish investment view.

Price Target Risks and Methodology - Daifuku (6383.T)

Our 12-month target price of ¥9,300 is based on FY12/29E EV/EBITDA, applying the sector-average multiple of 10X and a 80% sector-relative premium, with the obtained theoretical value discounted back to the midpoint of FY12/26E and FY12/27E with capital cost of 9%.

Key downside risks include slower investment from the tech, e-commerce, and automobile industries.

6383.T	12m Price Target: ¥9,300	Price: ¥5,429	Upside: 71.3%
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Buy	GS Forecast				
Market cap: ¥2.0tr / \$13.0bn Enterprise value: ¥1.8tr / \$11.6bn 3m ADTV: ¥10.9bn / \$68.1mn Japan Japan Industrials M&A Rank: 3 Leases incl. in net debt & EV?: No		12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
	Revenue (¥ bn)	660.7	732.0	855.0	891.0
	Op. profit (¥ bn)	100.8	125.0	147.0	157.0
	Op. profit CoE (¥ bn)	97.5	113.0	—	—
	EPS (¥)	212.4	245.8	289.1	308.7
	P/E (X)	19.3	22.1	18.8	17.6
	P/B (X)	3.3	3.9	3.4	3.0
	Dividend yield (%)	1.9	1.4	1.6	1.7
	N debt/EBITDA (ex lease,X)	(1.8)	(1.6)	(1.6)	(1.9)
	CROCI (%)	29.3	33.6	33.9	33.8
		3/26	6/26	9/26E	12/26E
	EPS (¥)	53.0	64.3	—	—

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates, FactSet. Price as of 11 Sep 2026 close.

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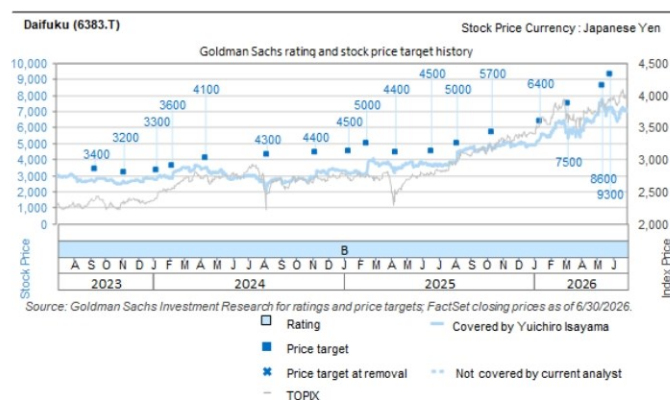
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Daifuku (6383.T)

Date of report	Target price (¥)	Closing price (¥)
28-May-26	9,300	7,263
14-May-26	8,600	7,502
09-Mar-26	7,500	5,359
14-Jan-26	6,400	5,363
13-Oct-25	5,700	4,768
07-Aug-25	5,000	3,976
20-Jun-25	4,500	3,628
11-Apr-25	4,400	3,439
14-Feb-25	5,000	3,155
12-Jan-25	4,500	3,190
08-Nov-24	4,400	2,951
08-Aug-24	4,300	2,367
12-Apr-24	4,100	3,498
08-Feb-24	3,600	2,878
08-Jan-24	3,300	2,755
08-Nov-23	3,200	2,611
13-Sep-23	3,400	2,725

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